Informatics Institute of Technology

affiliated with the

University Of Westminster

Module: 6BUIS018C

Information Driven Entrepreneurship and Enterprise

Coursework 1 - Enterprise Portfolio Part 1

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Executive Summary

Ascend is an AI-powered digital coaching marketplace designed to connect individuals and organizations with certified professional coaches across career development, leadership, performance optimization, and personal growth. The platform leverages intelligent matching algorithms, performance analytics, and enterprise integration capabilities to deliver scalable, measurable, and personalized coaching experiences.

In today's rapidly evolving professional landscape, organizations face increasing challenges in employee retention, leadership development, and workforce adaptability. Simultaneously, individuals seek structured guidance to navigate career transitions, skill gaps, and performance pressures. While existing global platforms such as BetterUp and CoachHub provide digital coaching services, they primarily target large enterprises and operate at premium price points. Ascend differentiates itself by offering a hybrid B2B and B2C model that is scalable, accessible, and optimized for emerging and mid-sized markets.

Ascend operates through a multi-sided marketplace model, onboarding certified coaches through a structured vetting process while targeting SMEs, startups, and individual professionals as primary customer segments. Strategic partnerships with corporations, educational institutions, and professional networks will drive adoption and credibility.

From a competitive standpoint, Ascend positions itself as a cost-efficient, AI-optimized, and regionally adaptable alternative to established global players. By focusing on underserved markets and offering measurable outcomes rather than generic coaching sessions, the platform establishes a strong differentiation strategy.

The long-term vision of Ascend is to become a leading digital workforce development ecosystem that not only connects users to coaches but also continuously enhances career trajectories through intelligent insights and adaptive learning pathways.

By combining advanced AI capabilities, scalable infrastructure, and a clearly defined market positioning strategy, Ascend is strategically positioned to capture growth in the global digital coaching and professional development industry

Task 1 - E-Business Idea and Feasibility Analysis

1.1 Introduction

Digital transformation, hybrid work environments, and the acceleration of knowledge economies have reshaped how professionals develop skills and leadership capabilities. Organizations increasingly prioritize structured coaching to improve engagement, retention, and performance. However, traditional coaching models remain fragmented, expensive, and geographically constrained. At the same time, individuals face difficulty identifying credible coaches, measuring progress, or accessing affordable mentorship.

Ascend responds to this structural gap by offering a scalable, AI-powered digital coaching marketplace that connects individuals and corporate clients with certified professional coaches through a data-driven, subscription-based platform. The platform is designed not merely as a marketplace but as a structured digital infrastructure that enables measurable human capital development for individuals, coaches, and organizations.

1.2 The Business Idea

Ascend is a fully digital, AI-enabled e-business platform designed to democratise access to professional coaching. It operates as an intelligent intermediary between three core stakeholders:

- **Individuals** seeking career and leadership development
- **Corporate clients** investing in employee growth
- Certified **professional coaches** offering services

The platform integrates:

- AI-powered coach - client matching
- Secure video coaching infrastructure
- Structured goal-setting and milestone tracking
- Performance analytics dashboards
- Feedback and rating mechanisms

- Subscription management and secure payment systems

The system integrates an LMS that allows users to access supplementary learning modules aligned with coaching objectives. Companies can combine coaching sessions with structured learning pathways to address skill gaps.

Key components include:

- AI-assisted coach matching algorithm
- Structured development goal tracking
- Organisational analytics dashboards
- Integrated LMS modules
- Secure digital payment and scheduling system

The AI engine analyses user profiles, development goals, behavioural inputs, and feedback patterns to optimise matching and continuously refine recommendations. This data-driven mechanism enhances personalisation, reduces friction in coach selection, and increases measurable outcomes.

For corporate clients, Ascend provides centralised dashboards enabling HR departments to track engagement levels, coaching utilisation rates, and performance metrics, thereby linking coaching investments to organisational objectives.

1.3 Revenue Model and Monetisation Strategy

Ascend adopts a diversified yet strategically coherent revenue model:

1. Subscription-Based Individual Plans (B2C)

Tiered monthly packages:

- Basic (limited sessions, AI matching only)
- Professional (enhanced tracking and feedback tools)
- Executive (priority coach access and advanced analytics)

2. Corporate Licensing Model (B2B)

- Bulk subscription packages based on employee volume
- Custom reporting dashboards
- Dedicated account management
- Integration with HR systems

3. Commission-Based Earnings

A percentage commission deducted from each coaching session conducted through the platform.

4. Premium Add-On Services

- AI-enhanced leadership assessments
- Industry-specific coaching modules
- Executive development programmes

This hybrid model ensures recurring revenue stability while maintaining scalability. Subscription income improves cash flow predictability, while commissions align platform incentives with coaching engagement levels.

1.4 Target Market and Audience

The platform targets three key segments:

1. Corporate Clients - B2B Segment:

- SMEs investing in employee engagement strategies
- HR and Learning & Development departments
- Companies in emerging markets lacking structured development frameworks

2. Individual Professionals - B2C Segment:

- Early-career employees navigating progression pathways
- Mid-level managers seeking leadership capability development

- Entrepreneurs and startup founders

These individuals often face high coaching costs, limited access to qualified professionals, and lack of measurable progress tracking.

3. Professional Coaches - B2C Segment:
Independent certified coaches seeking digital exposure, structured client acquisition, and performance tracking tools.

The increasing demand for digital learning and performance management systems creates a favourable market environment for this solution.

1.5 Mission Statement

Ascend's mission is:

> *"To democratise and personalise professional coaching through intelligent digital infrastructure, enabling measurable growth for individuals and organisations worldwide."*

The mission reflects three pillars: accessibility, intelligence, and measurable impact.

1.6 Rich Picture

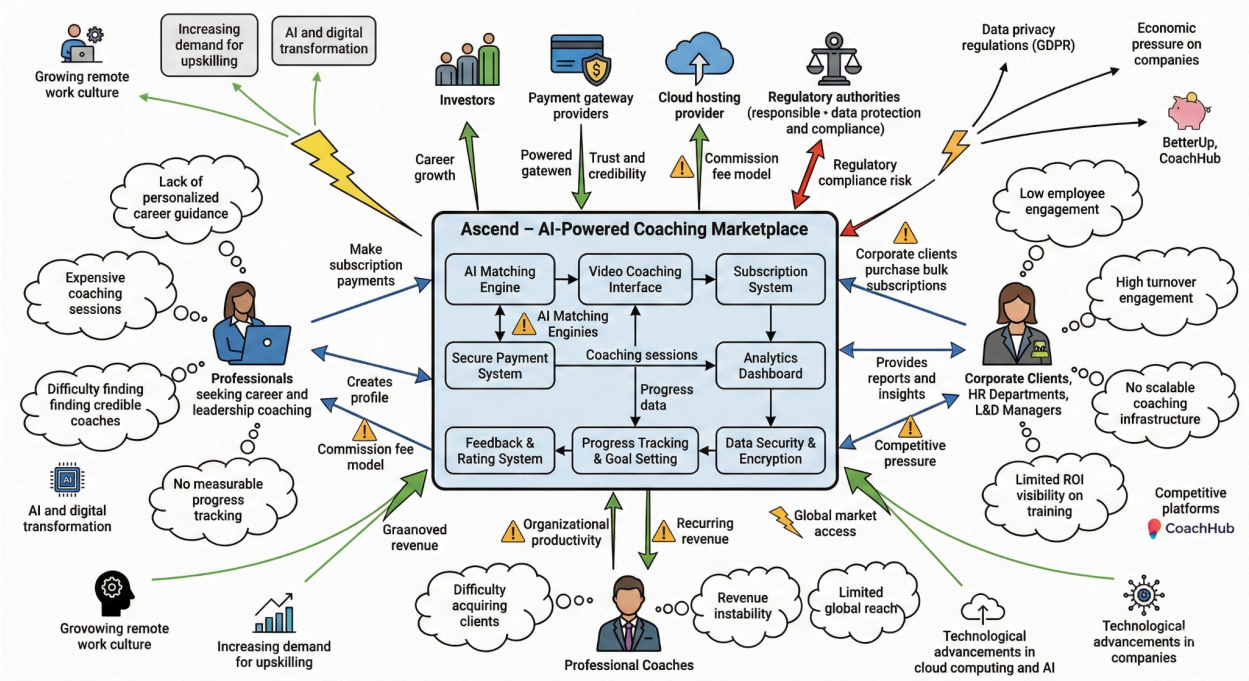


Figure 01 - Rich Picture

The above image was generated using AI with the assistance of Google Gemini. However, the Rich Picture analysis and interpretation were conducted independently by the research team. The corresponding Rich Picture and its analytical explanation are provided in the *Appendix* for reference.

For the detailed Rich Picture Analysis, refer Appendix A1.

1.7 E-Business Classification and Business Model Analysis

1.7.1 Form of Operation

Ascend operates as a **platform based digital marketplace**, and is classified as a dotcom organisation. It does not directly employ coaches but facilitates interactions and transactions between independent service providers and clients. This asset-light structure enhances scalability and reduces fixed costs.

Unlike traditional consulting firms (dotcorp organisations), this platform is digitally native. It has an online ecosystem with operations, customer interactions, revenue generation, and value creation fully embedded within it. Thus, this business operates as a dotcom platform.

1.7.2 Degree of Digitization

This platform can be categorised as a pure e-business, as all three key dimensions of digitisation (product, process, and delivery) are conducted digitally.

The table below explains how each dimension has been digitised.

Dimension	Digital Implementation	Explanation
Product	Yes	Coaching services are delivered through online video and digital communication tools.
Process	Yes	AI-assisted matching, session scheduling, billing, analytics, and reporting are automated within the platform.
Delivery	Yes	Sessions are conducted via integrated video conferencing.

Table 01 - Degree of Digitisation

Although coaching involves human interaction, no physical interaction is required during the entire service lifecycle. From onboarding and matching to performance measurement and payment processing is digitally mediated, justifying the platform as a pure e-business.

1.7.3 Classification according to participants

Ascend operates under:

- **B2C model** (platform to individual professionals)
- **B2B model** (platform to corporate clients)
- **C2C intermediation** (independent coaches delivering services via the platform)

This hybrid structure increases market coverage and revenue diversification.

1.7.4 Classification by E-Marketplaces

1.7.4.1. According to Industry Areas

Horizontal Marketplace:

Spans multiple industries (digital transformation, data analytics, personal development, corporate training) and mediates common services rather than serving a single industry

1.7.4.2. According to Facilitator

Intermediary-Oriented Marketplace:

Acts as a neutral intermediary between buyers (organisations/individuals) and sellers (specialists/coaches) and facilitates information exchange, discovery, transactions, and recommendations

1.7.4.3. According to Number of Participants

Butterfly Model:

Many buyers, many sellers and Supports scalability and network effects

1.7.4.4. Subscription & Service Provider Model

The platform integrates subscription-based access with commission-based service provision, combining SaaS and marketplace economics.

1.8 Competitive Analysis

1.8.1 Industry Overview

The digital coaching and leadership development market has expanded significantly due to:

- Increased remote workforce models

- Demand for scalable employee development
- Rising leadership competency requirements
- Digital transformation of HR functions

Organisations increasingly seek measurable ROI from development investments, creating demand for data-driven coaching platforms. Technology-driven platforms increasingly dominate over traditional in-person coaching.

1.8.2 Identification of Major Competitors

Primary competitors include:

- BetterUp - https://www.betterup.com/
- CoachHub - https://www.coachhub.com/
- Fiverr - https://www.fiverr.com/

Both focus primarily on enterprise-level clients and structured leadership programmes.

1.8.3 Competitor Analysis

Feature	AscendOS (Proposed)	BetterUp	CoachHub	Fiverr
Individual (B2C) Access	Yes	Limited	No	Yes
SME Focus	Strong	Limited	Limited	No
Enterprise (B2B) Packages	Yes	Yes	Yes	No
AI-Based Matching	Advanced	Yes	Moderate	No
Structured LMS Integration	Yes	Limited	No	No
Transparent Pricing	Yes	No	Limited	Yes
Measurable ROI Dashboards	Advanced	Advanced	Moderate	Basic
Quality-Controlled Coach Vetting	Yes	Yes	Yes	No
Emerging Market Accessibility	Strong	Limited	Moderate	Moderate
Marketplace Flexibility	High	Low	Low	High

Table 02 - Competitor Analysis

Strategic Positioning Analysis

The competitive landscape reveals clear segmentation:

- BetterUp and CoachHub dominate the high-cost enterprise segment.
- Fiverr dominates the low-cost, unstructured freelance segment.

However, there is limited competition targeting:

- SMEs requiring structured yet affordable coaching

- Individual professionals seeking measurable development
- Organisations needing LMS integration combined with coaching
- Emerging markets requiring price-accessible digital coaching

Ascend occupies this underserved middle-market position.

1.8.4 Competitive Advantage Strategy

Ascend's competitive advantage is built on three strategic pillars:

1. Intelligent Matching Algorithms

Ascend uses AI-driven profiling to match coaches and clients based on goals, behavioural traits, and performance data. This increases session effectiveness and client satisfaction.

2. Integration of Coaching with Structured LMS Pathways

Ascend combines coaching sessions with structured learning modules and milestone tracking. This hybrid model bridges the gap between pure coaching platforms and digital learning systems.

3. Measurable Performance Dashboards

Corporate clients gain access to structured ROI tracking dashboards, linking coaching engagement with performance indicators.

1.9 Feasibility Justification

- **Technical Feasibility -** Cloud computing, AI algorithms & secure payment gateways are mature technologies. The platform can be developed using scalable microservices architecture.
- **Market Feasibility -** Demand for coaching and professional development continues to grow globally, supported by workforce transformation trends.
- **Financial Feasibility -** The subscription-based recurring revenue model enhances sustainability.
- **Operational Feasibility -** The asset-light model enables lean operations, focusing on

quality assurance, onboarding processes, and platform optimisation rather than direct service delivery.

Collectively, these factors indicate strong feasibility across strategic, financial, and technological dimensions.

1.10 Video Pitch

The video pitch has been uploaded to YouTube.

Youtube URL: https://youtu.be/-C0joNme4K8

Google drive URL
https://drive.google.com/drive/folders/1W3Ks1FZ1li_IxUU9NE-TLm1F2VOSfM-R?usp=drive_link

Task 2 - IT Strategic Analysis of the Business

2.1 Introduction

Strategic analysis is essential in evaluating the competitive positioning and long-term viability of the proposed intelligent Coaching ecosystem. As a hybrid marketplace, SaaS platform, and LMS-enabled development infrastructure, the business operates within a highly competitive digital environment.

This section applies established strategic analysis tools to assess industry dynamics, internal capabilities, macro-environmental influences, and IT alignment. The analysis ensures that the business strategy and technological infrastructure are coherently integrated to achieve sustainable competitive advantage.

2.2 Selection and Justification of Strategic Analysis Tools

To evaluate the proposed platform comprehensively, the following strategic tools are selected:

- Porter's Five Forces
- SWOT Analysis
- PESTEL Analysis
- Business Model Canvas

Justification:

Porter's Five Forces evaluates industry competitiveness and structural profitability. SWOT identifies internal strengths and weaknesses alongside external opportunities and threats. PESTEL assesses macro-environmental factors influencing operations. The Business Model Canvas provides a structured view of value creation, revenue logic, and customer relationships.

Together, these tools offer a holistic understanding of both business strategy and IT-enabled competitive positioning.

2.3 Strategic Analysis Using Selected Tools

2.3.1 Porter's Five Forces Analysis

The Porter's Five Forces model assesses the industry the platform belongs to by analysing entry barriers, bargaining power of buyers and suppliers, substitutes, and competitive rivalry.

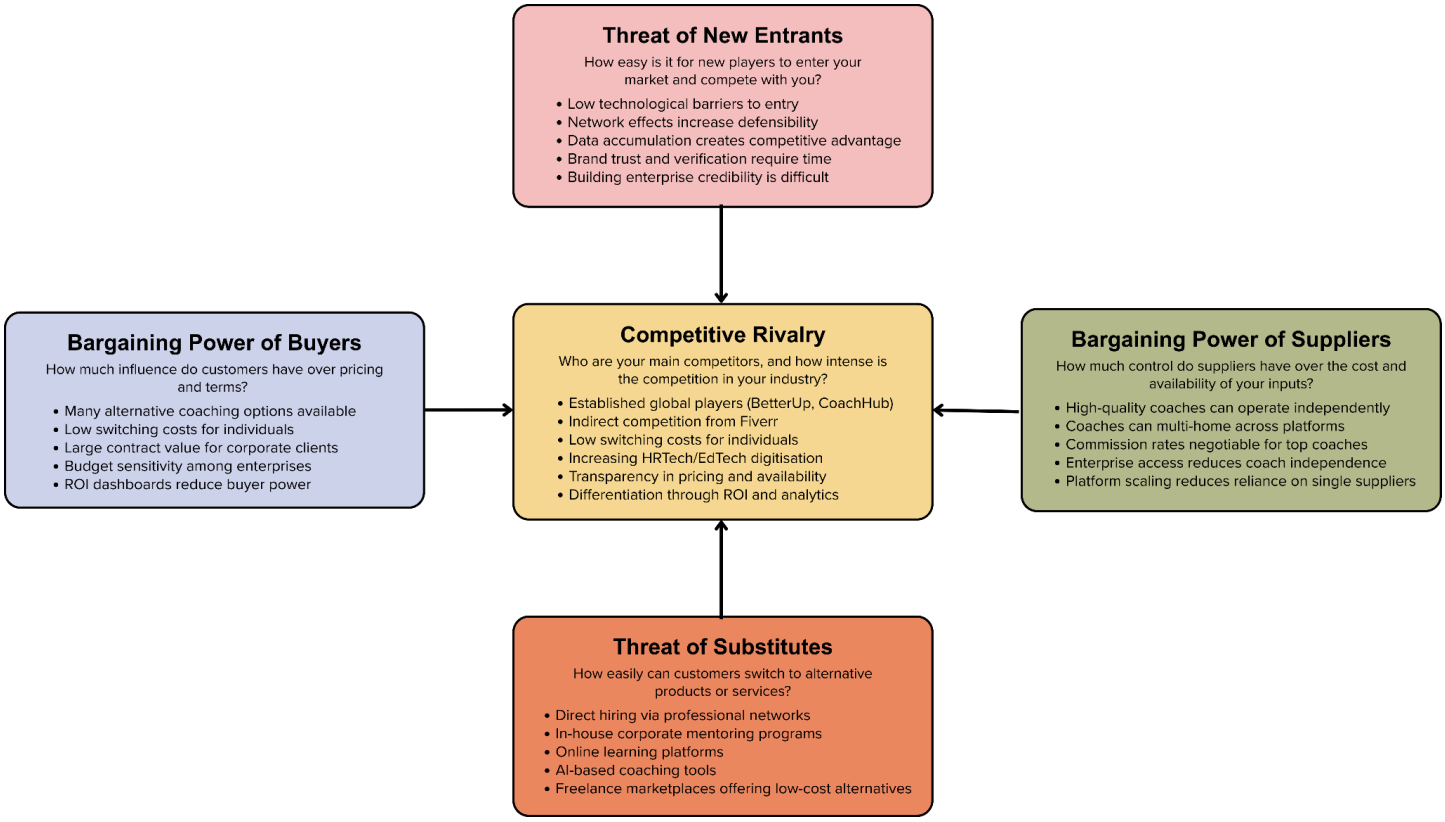


Figure 02 - Porter's Five Forces analysis

1. Threat of New Entrants – Moderate

Technological barriers to building a digital platform are relatively low due to accessible cloud infrastructure and development tools. Thus, making basic platform creation feasible.

However, long-term defensibility depends on network effects, data accumulation improving algorithm-based matching and ROI analytics, and established brand trust.

Although entry to the market is technologically feasible, building a trusted, outcome-driven ecosystem is significantly more complex. Therefore, the threat of new entrants is moderate.

2. Bargaining Power of Buyers – Moderate

Individual Clients

Individual users have high bargaining power because of availability of alternative coaching options, ability to contact coaches independently and minimal switching costs.

The platform reduces this power through intelligent matching, verified quality assurance, structured progress tracking, and outcome measurement. This increases the value of the platform beyond simply booking sessions.

Corporate Clients

Corporate clients possess bargaining power due to larger contract sizes and budget sensitivity.

However, integration into HR systems, structured programs, and ROI dashboards increase switching costs over time due to data history and process integration. Thus, enterprise buyer power is moderate.

3. Bargaining Power of Suppliers – Moderate

In this ecosystem, coaches act as suppliers of services and may possess significant bargaining power because they can operate independently, use multiple platforms, and negotiate commissions.

The platform mitigates this supplier power through access to enterprise and corporate clients, analytics tools, LMS integration, and a transparent commission structure.

As the platform scales and the number of coaches increases, dependence on any single coach decreases, reducing overall supplier influence. Therefore, overall supplier power is moderate.

4. Threat of Substitutes – High

Substitutes include in-person coaching, in-house mentoring,online learning platforms, AI tools and freelance marketplaces. The most significant substitute threat is companies bypassing platforms and hiring coaches directly via professional networks. Nevertheless, this alone cannot provide structured matching, progress analytics, or measurable impact tracking. Therefore, although substitutes are accessible, they lack integrated ecosystem capabilities.

5. Competitive Rivalry – High

The digital coaching space includes established players such as BetterUp and CoachHub, which operate globally with strong enterprise partnerships and technological infrastructure. In addition to direct competitors, freelance marketplaces such as Fiverr pose indirect price competition.

Competitive rivalry is intensified by low switching costs, digital platform expansion, remote work growth, and pricing transparency.

However, the platform differentiates itself through AI-assisted matching, ROI dashboards, performance scoring, and enterprise-grade program management tools.

Overall Industry Attractiveness Assessment

The digital coaching industry exhibits high rivalry and substitutes, with moderate entry, buyer, and supplier power.

Despite competitive pressures, the industry remains attractive due to growing corporate investment in leadership development, remote work expansion, employee wellbeing focus, and demand for measurable HR impact.

The proposed platform’s outcome-driven positioning, enterprise integration, and data-driven ecosystem strengthen its strategic position within a competitive but expanding market.

2.3.2 SWOT Matrix Analysis

INTERNAL / EXTERNAL FACTORS	**Strengths (S)** **S1.** AI-assisted skill-gap-based matching algorithm. **S2.** Hybrid revenue model (B2B + B2C). **S3.** Advanced corporate analytics & ROI dashboards. **S4.** Integrated Marketplace + Coaching LMS system.	**Weaknesses (W)** **W1.** "Cold Start" two-sided marketplace problem. **W2.** Limited initial brand trust vs. established firms. **W3.** Long B2B enterprise sales cycles.
Opportunities (O) **O1.** Corporate shift toward remote professional development. **O2.** Growing demand for measurable ROI in corporate L&D. **O3.** Underserved SME market segment.	**SO Strategies (Attacking)** **Combine S3, S4, O2:** Combine the integrated LMS and analytics dashboards to directly capture corporate L&D budgets that demand measurable outcomes. **Use S2, O3:** Use the hybrid B2B subscription model to aggressively target the underserved SME market.	**WO Strategies (Build Strengths)** **Combine W1, W3, O3:** Bypass long enterprise sales cycles and the "cold start" problem by initially targeting SMEs; a faster B2B adoption rate will quickly build the user base needed to attract top coaches.
Threats (T) **T1.** Large tech platforms replicating matchmaking features. **T2.** Economic downturns reducing corporate training budgets. **T3.** Coach disintermediation risk (coaches bypassing the platform).	**ST Strategies (Defensive)** **Combine S3, S4, T3:** Prevent coach disintermediation by locking clients and coaches into the integrated LMS and analytics dashboards—tools coaches cannot easily replicate independently. **Use S2, T2:** Lean on the hybrid revenue model to pivot marketing toward individual	**WT Strategies (Build Defenses)** **Combine W2, T1:** Counteract big-tech clones and your lack of initial brand trust by specializing deeply in niche, high-demand technical upskilling rather than general life coaching, minimizing direct head-to-head competition early on.

Figure 03 - SWOT Matrix Analysis

Analysis:

The key strength lies in combining marketplace functionality with structured learning and measurable performance tracking. However, early-stage brand recognition and competition pose challenges. Strategic partnerships and phased rollout can mitigate these risks.

2.3.3 PESTEL Analysis

- **Political:** Government focus on workforce upskilling and the potential for public sector contracts drive demand. Stability and trade agreements further influence international service delivery.

- **Economic:** Fluctuating corporate budgets favor cost-effective digital solutions with measurable ROI over traditional consultants. The growing gig economy and SME demand provide a scalable supply and customer base.

- **Social:** Increasing prioritization of emotional intelligence and employee wellbeing, alongside the normalization of virtual coaching, drives market acceptance. A cultural shift toward empathetic leadership necessitates structured development.

- **Technological:** Reliable video tools enable seamless delivery, while AI optimizes client-coach matching and progress tracking. Robust cybersecurity is required to protect sensitive data at scale.

- **Legal:** Mandatory compliance with regulations like GDPR ensures trust given the confidential nature of coaching. Classifying coaches as independent contractors and navigating cross-border taxes are critical legal considerations.

- **Environmental:** 100% online operations eliminate travel, reducing carbon footprints and supporting corporate ESG goals through paperless, digital delivery.

Justification for Selection

We selected PESTEL analysis to identify macro-environmental factors impacting Ascend's scalability. By evaluating external variables like shifting HR budgets, evolving data privacy mandates, and the rise of remote development, we ensure the strategy remains resilient to market shifts internal analysis cannot capture.

2.4 Additional Strategic Model

2.4.1 Business Model Canvas

"..the conceptualizations of the use of the BMC measures entrepreneurial performance and address long-term projections." (Murray and Scuotto)



Figure 04 - Business Model Canvas

2.5 IT Strategy Alignment

The IT strategy directly supports business objectives. The platform's differentiation depends on technological capabilities, particularly:

- AI-based matching algorithm
- Secure authentication and payment systems
- Cloud-based scalability
- Role-based dashboards

- LMS integration

IT is not merely supportive but strategic. The business value proposition relies on data processing, analytics, and digital infrastructure. Alignment is achieved through modular system architecture, allowing incremental feature expansion without disrupting core operations.

Cloud-native deployment ensures scalability as user adoption increases. Security protocols align with legal compliance requirements, protecting organisational and individual data.

2.6 Strategic Positioning in the Market

The platform positions itself between high-cost enterprise coaching platforms and unstructured freelance marketplaces.

Unlike enterprise-only platforms such as BetterUp, the proposed system focuses on SMEs and mid-level professionals. Unlike freelance marketplaces, it offers structured performance tracking and LMS integration.

This positioning creates a mid-market niche targeting organisations seeking affordability, structure, and measurable outcomes.

By integrating coaching and learning management within one ecosystem, the platform differentiates itself through functional depth rather than price competition alone.

2.7 Summary of Business Strategy

The overall business strategy combines:

- Differentiation through intelligent matching and analytics
- Cost accessibility for SMEs
- Hybrid revenue streams for financial sustainability
- IT-driven scalability

The platform adopts a digital ecosystem approach rather than a simple intermediary model. Strategic focus is placed on measurable impact, transparency, and structured development pathways.

By aligning technology with competitive positioning, the business aims to achieve sustainable advantage in a growing digital professional development market.

2.8 Conclusion

This strategic analysis demonstrates that the proposed intelligent e-Coaching ecosystem operates in a competitive but opportunity-rich environment. While industry rivalry and substitute threats are significant, differentiation through LMS integration, AI-driven matching, and measurable performance dashboards strengthens market viability.

The selected strategic models confirm that the platform's hybrid marketplace-SaaS structure is aligned with macro trends, technological capabilities, and evolving organisational needs.

Effective IT alignment, strategic positioning toward SMEs, and diversified revenue streams support long-term scalability and sustainability.

Task 3 - User Requirements and High-Level System Design Specification

3.1 Introduction

This section presents the user requirements and high-level system design specification for **Ascend**, the intelligent digital coaching ecosystem. The purpose of this task is to translate the business concept into structured system requirements and architectural components that demonstrate technical feasibility and strategic alignment.

Ascend operates as a hybrid e-business model, combining a structured Learning Management System (LMS), an intelligent coach-matching engine, and enterprise-level analytics dashboards. Therefore, the system design must support multi-actor interactions, measurable performance tracking, secure financial operations, and scalable SaaS infrastructure.

A structured requirements analysis ensures alignment between stakeholder expectations, operational efficiency, and long-term growth objectives.

3.2 User Requirements Analysis

3.2.1 Identification of System Actors

The system includes four primary actors:

1. **Individual User (B2C Client)**
   Professionals seeking personal development, leadership coaching, or structured learning programmes.
2. **Coach**
   Verified coaching professionals offering services, managing clients, and tracking engagement.

3. **Company Administrator (HR / Manager)**
   Corporate representatives responsible for allocating coaching credits, monitoring employee engagement, and measuring return on investment (ROI).
4. **System Administrator**
   Platform governance authority responsible for compliance, verification, analytics monitoring, and content management.

Role-based access control is essential to ensure secure and differentiated functionality for each actor.

3.2.2 Functional Requirements

The system must provide the following core functional capabilities:

1. Identity and Access Management

   - Secure registration and login
   - Multi-factor authentication
   - Role-based dashboard access

2. Intelligent Coach Matching

   - Goal-based input assessment
   - AI-powered matching algorithm
   - Filter by expertise, pricing, industry, language
   - Ranked recommendations

3. Session Scheduling and Collaboration

   - Integrated calendar system
   - Automated booking confirmations
   - Video conferencing API integration

4. Payment and Revenue Management

- Secure payment gateway integration
- Corporate credit allocation system
- Automated invoicing
- Revenue tracking for coaches

5. Learning Management System (LMS)

- Access to structured learning pathways
- Module completion tracking
- Skill assessment quizzes
- Certificate generation

6. Corporate Dashboard & Analytics

- Employee engagement metrics
- Coaching utilisation tracking
- Performance improvement indicators
- ROI reporting tools

7. Governance and Quality Assurance

- Coach verification workflows
- Feedback and rating mechanisms
- Content moderation

These functional capabilities support Ascend's strategic objective of bridging enterprise-grade coaching with SME accessibility.

3.2.3 Non-Functional Requirements

The system must satisfy the following quality attributes:

1. Security
    - End-to-end encryption
    - GDPR-compliant data handling

2. Scalability
    - Cloud-based microservices architecture
    - Elastic resource allocation to support growth

3. Performance
    - Response time under 3 seconds
    - Real-time analytics dashboard updates

4. Availability
    - Minimum 99.5% uptime

5. Usability
    - Intuitive UI/UX
    - Mobile and desktop compatibility

6. Maintainability
    - Modular code structure
    - API-first architecture

7. Interoperability
    - Integration with third-party LMS systems
    - Payment gateways

Non-functional requirements ensure platform sustainability and enterprise credibility.

3.2.4 Requirements - Use Case Mapping Table

Use Case Name	Primary Actor	Mapped Functional Features	Mapped Non-Functional Requirements
Identity & Access Management	All Actors	User Management & Identity Governance, Platform Administration & Governance	Security, Privacy & Compliance, Auditability
Coach Onboarding & Vetting	Coach, System Admin	Advanced Coach Onboarding & Credentialing, Certification & Credentialing Engine	Privacy & Compliance, Usability
Workforce & Dept. Config	Company Admin	Company Workforce Configuration System	Interoperability
AI Matching & Discovery	Individual, Admin	AI-Powered Coach Discovery & Talent Intelligence, AI Skill Simulation & Practice Lab	Performance
Program & LMS Engagement	Individual, Coach	Structured Coaching Program Engine (LMS Layer), Certification & Credentialing Engine	Scalability, Maintainability
Session Execution & Collab	Individual, Coach	Session Scheduling & Collaboration	Reliability & Availability, Usability

Financial Operations	Admin, Coach	Smart Payment & Revenue System	Security, Privacy & Compliance
Quality & Governance	System Admin	Feedback, Ratings & Performance Governance, Platform Administration & Governance	Auditability
ROI & Talent Intelligence	Company Admin	Analytics & Workforce Intelligence	Performance, Interoperability

Table 03 - Use Case Mapping

This mapping clarifies the relationship between actors and system functionalities.

3.3 Use Case Modelling

3.3.1 Simplified Use Case Diagram

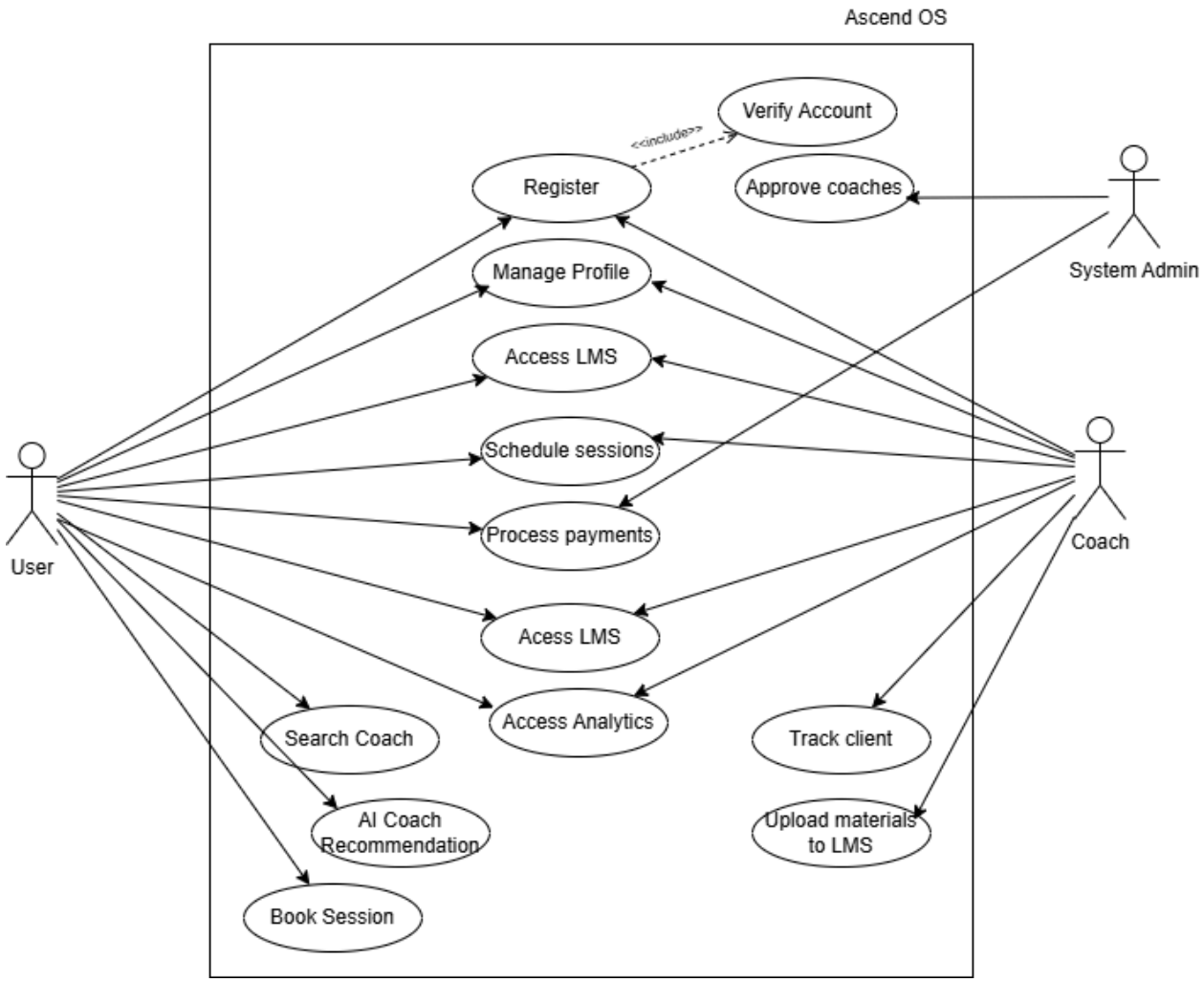


Figure 05 - Use Case Diagram

3.4 Formal Use Case Description

3.4.1 Selected Use Case:

This use case is central to the platform's value proposition.

Use Case Name	Intelligent Coach Matching
Use Case ID	UC-001
Description	The system generates personalised coach recommendations based on user goals, preferences, and behavioural inputs.
Priority	High
Primary Actor	Registered User
Supporting Actors	System
Pre-Conditions	• User is authenticated • Profile completed • Development goals submitted
Trigger	The user clicks on "Find a Coach"
Main flow	1. User enters development objectives. 2. System prompts for filters (budget, industry, language). 3. The matching engine processes criteria. 4. The system generates a ranked coach list. 5. User views profile. 6. User proceeds to booking.
Alternate flow	If no suitable match is found, the system recommends broadening filters.
Exclusions	Use case does not include the cancellation process

Post Conditions	1. Recommendation list displayed 2. User can proceed to booking

Table 04 - Use Case Description

3.5 Additional UML Modelling Technique

3.5.1 Selected Model and Justification for Selection

Selected Model: UML Class Diagram

Justification: A UML Class Diagram was selected because Ascend's core business differentiators, specifically the AI-assisted matching algorithm and corporate ROI dashboards, require a highly structured relational data model. The diagram maps the connections between Company, User, Coach, and LMSModule, illustrating exactly how the system aggregates data for B2B analytics and matches specific user attributes to coach expertise to facilitate the marketplace.

3.5.2 UML Diagram

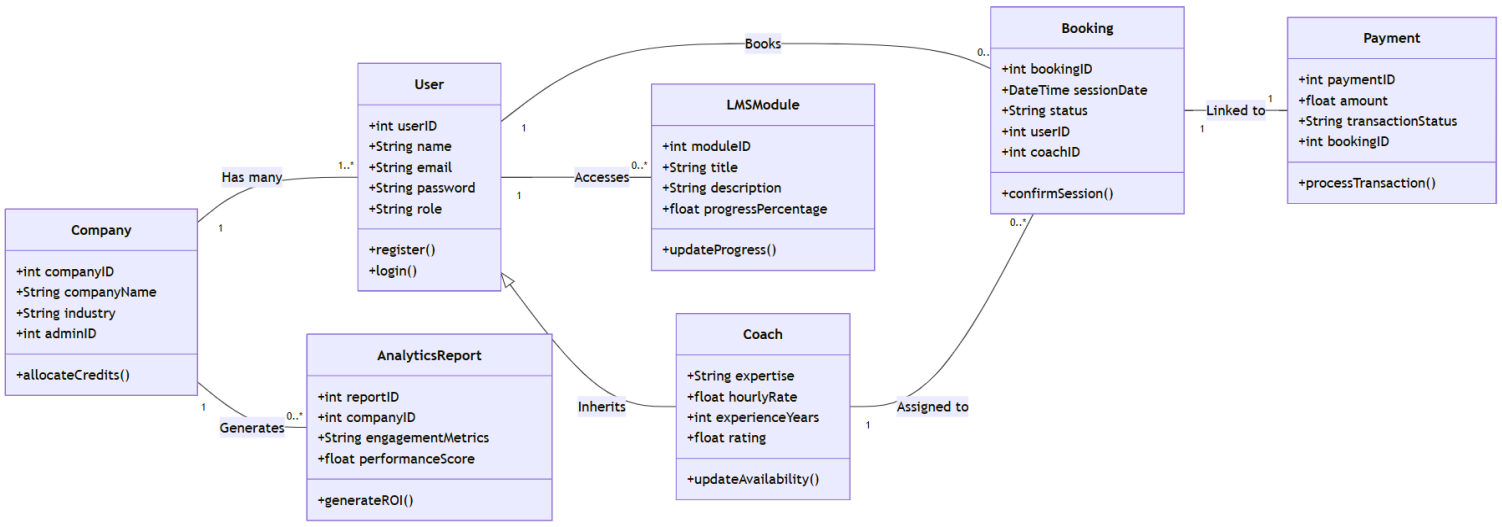


Figure 06 - Class Diagram

3.6 Design Justification and Business Alignment

The system architecture directly supports Ascend's hybrid marketplace-SaaS positioning as defined in Task 1.

- The intelligent matching engine enables differentiation from unstructured freelance platforms.
- The LMS integration supports structured development rather than isolated sessions.
- Corporate dashboards ensure measurable ROI, reinforcing enterprise credibility.

The modular design supports future AI-driven analytics expansion.
Cloud scalability enables mid-market targeting without enterprise-level infrastructure costs.

By integrating marketplace dynamics with structured learning and measurable performance analytics, the system design operationalizes Ascend's competitive strategy.

3.7 Conclusion

This section has defined the core user requirements and high-level design architecture for Ascend. The identification of actors, structured functional and non-functional requirements, formal use case modelling, and class diagram specification demonstrate technical feasibility and strategic alignment.

The proposed system extends beyond a simple coaching marketplace. It represents a scalable, secure, and analytics-driven digital development ecosystem designed to serve individuals, SMEs, and corporate clients within a measurable performance framework.

Task 4 - Individual Role in the Business and Group Mentoring Reflection

Saad Mazhar- Chief Executive Officer (CEO)

In a commercial context, I would assume the role of Chief Executive Officer, responsible for leading AscendOS's strategic direction, ensuring long-term organisational sustainability, and aligning all functional divisions with the company's overarching vision. My core executive responsibilities would encompass investment acquisition, strategic partnership development, revenue model validation, and cross-functional oversight, integrating product, technology, operations, and marketing into a coherent, scalable growth strategy.

I consider myself well-suited for this position, as my suitability is grounded in demonstrated experience in entrepreneurial initiative and applied strategic planning. During the academic development of AscendOS, my key contributions included the design of the hybrid B2B/B2C revenue model, the identification and refinement of the SME target segment, and the alignment of established strategic frameworks, including SWOT analysis, PESTEL, and Porter's Five Forces with the proposed system architecture. These contributions reflect the integrative, vision-driven thinking that effective chief executive leadership demands. I believe the CEO role is central to AscendOS's objective of scalable growth, as it ensures that innovation in artificial intelligence and product design translates into measurable financial and market outcomes.

My participation in group mentoring sessions materially strengthened my strategic thinking and the overall foundation of AscendOS. Feedback received during the second mentoring session advised against broad market positioning, which prompted me to advocate for a deliberate narrowing of focus toward the SME segment and a more clearly differentiated competitive stance against established global coaching platforms.

The most consequential feedback I personally received concerned the necessity of maintaining consistency between business strategy and system functionality, ensuring that technical features such as AI-driven matching and analytics dashboards, were directly traceable to defined strategic objectives. I found this principle instrumental in reinforcing the overall coherence and credibility

of the AscendOS proposal, affirming my view that sustainable competitive advantage emerges when strategic intent and operational design remain continuously and explicitly aligned.

Humayra Shajahan – Chief Technology Officer (CTO)

If the business idea were implemented, I would take on the role of Chief Technology Officer (CTO) at Ascend. In this role, I would be responsible for designing and overseeing the technical infrastructure that supports the platform's AI-driven value proposition. My key responsibilities would include developing the intelligent matching algorithm, ensuring cybersecurity and data protection compliance, and building a scalable cloud-based architecture capable of supporting both SMEs and enterprise clients. I would also oversee system integrations, performance optimisation, and continuous technological improvement.

I believe I am suitable for this role due to my analytical skills and ability to translate business concepts into structured technical solutions. During the coursework, I contributed to defining functional and non-functional requirements, supported UML modelling, and evaluated the feasibility of the AI-based matching mechanism. These tasks required structured thinking and alignment between technical design and business objectives, which reflects the core responsibilities of a CTO.

The CTO role is strategically important to Ascend's success. The company's competitive advantage depends on delivering reliable, secure, and data-driven coaching solutions. A strong technical foundation ensures system scalability, protects sensitive organisational data, and enhances user trust. Without a robust architecture, the platform would struggle to achieve its strategic goals of measurable outcomes and sustainable growth.

The mentoring sessions significantly supported my development. In one session, we received feedback emphasising the importance of focusing on a Minimum Viable Product (MVP) rather than implementing too many advanced features initially. This guidance helped refine our system scope to prioritise core functionalities. The most important advice I received was to design for scalability from the outset. This strengthened our architectural proposal and ensured alignment with long-term strategy.

Dhuwarakesh Vijayakumar – Chief Product Officer (CPO)

If Ascend were to become a real business, I'd take the role of Chief Product Officer. My main job would be to lead the product roadmap and make sure the platform is actually easy for people to use. I'd be responsible for balancing our smart features, like the AI matching, with a design that is simple enough for HR managers and employees to navigate without getting frustrated.

I'm a good fit for this because my actual career is already following a very similar path. This professional background helped me bring a structured approach to the project, making sure our requirements weren't just "cool ideas" but were actually designed to solve real problems. I'm comfortable bridging the gap between business needs and the technical side of things, which is exactly what a CPO has to do to keep a product growing.

Beyond the initial setup, my focus would be on how we scale the platform after the launch. This means looking at user data to see which features people actually find helpful and which ones we need to fix. A huge part of my role is making sure that as we add more complex AI tools, we don't lose the user-friendly feel that makes Ascend different. It's about building a product that doesn't just work well today but evolves and grows alongside the companies that use it.

The group mentoring sessions were a big turning point for me. One of the best pieces of advice we got was about making our product stand out by focusing on deeper value. That changed my whole view of the project. Instead of just a simple directory, I pushed for a "Talent Intelligence" model that uses data and predictive matching to give us a real edge over competitors. The most important lesson I learned was to always design for the person actually using the app rather than just focusing on what the technology is capable of. This mindset is what ultimately made Ascend a practical tool that provides the kind of data insights companies actually need.

Raahim Aslam – Chief Marketing Officer (CMO)

If this business idea went ahead, I would assume the role of the Chief Marketing Officer (CMO) of Ascend. My key responsibilities would include leading the company's marketing and brand strategy, defining market positioning, and driving growth initiatives. This would involve overseeing digital marketing campaigns, corporate outreach, establishing strategic enterprise partnerships, ensuring consistent communication of our outcome-driven coaching model, and long-term brand development to increase platform adoption. Additionally, I would also manage customer acquisition strategies across both B2C and B2B segments, ensuring alignment between competitive positioning and measurable business impact.

I am well-suited for this role due to my experience in translating strategic concepts into clear value propositions. During the coursework, I contributed to analysing the business environment, categorising the platform's operational model, and assessing its degree of digitisation. I also played a central role in developing the Porter's Five Forces analysis, allowing us to define our differentiation strategy and value creation approach. A key focus was positioning coaching as a measurable investment rather than an expense. The CMO role is critical to achieve Ascend's strategic objectives, especially when navigating high competitive rivalry and substitute threats because without strong branding and clear value communication, the platform would struggle to gain market traction.

The group mentoring sessions significantly helped shape my marketing perspective. In one session, we were encouraged to expand our features and create a clear competitive differentiation. This guidance strengthened our outcome-driven positioning and refined our messaging around ROI and enterprise integration. Another important advice received was to ensure there was full consistency between the strategic analysis and business design decisions. This reinforced the importance of aligning marketing strategy with system capabilities, ensuring that Ascend's external communication accurately reflects its internal strengths and long-term competitive advantage.

Ayash Azhar– Chief Operations & Compliance Officer (COO)

As Chief Operations and Compliance Officer (COO), I would oversee the operational infrastructure of Ascend, ensuring efficient service delivery, regulatory compliance, and quality assurance. My responsibilities include coach verification procedures, payment processing systems, data protection compliance, and monitoring performance standards. I would also manage risk assessment processes to safeguard long-term sustainability.

My experience bridging technical architecture with business strategy makes me well-suited for this role. Having previously managed project workflows and coordinated large community initiatives, I bring a highly structured, detail-oriented approach to execution. During this coursework, I directly applied this by analyzing operational practicality, leading the SWOT analysis, defining non-functional requirements, and validating our cost structures. The COO role is strategically vital; our competitive advantage relies entirely on enterprise trust, which is only possible through strict regulatory adherence and flawless platform reliability.

The group mentoring sessions were instrumental in shaping this operational focus. Specifically, during our Progress Review (Meeting 4), the guidance highlighted that data privacy and security could not be treated as secondary features. We were advised to embed these legal considerations directly into the early system design phase. This feedback prompted me to heavily strengthen our non-functional requirements around GDPR compliance and encryption.

The most important piece of advice I personally received was the absolute necessity of anticipating operational and security challenges before market entry. For an information-driven coaching platform, a single privacy breach could destroy our brand trust permanently. This perspective fundamentally shifted my approach, ensuring that Ascend was designed from the ground up as a robust, legally compliant, and professionally structured enterprise.

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Appendix

Appendix A

Appendix A1 - Rich Picture Analysis

The rich picture illustrates the overall ecosystem of the Ascend AI-Powered Coaching Marketplace, showing how different stakeholders interact with the platform, the problems they face, and the external factors influencing the system.

The Ascend platform is positioned at the centre, acting as a digital intermediary connecting professionals, coaches, and corporate clients while integrating technological infrastructure and regulatory oversight.

1. Central Platform - Ascend AI Coaching Marketplace

The core system integrates multiple components that enable the coaching ecosystem.

Key internal system components

- **AI Matching Engine**
    - Matches professionals with suitable coaches based on goals, industry, experience, and preferences.
    - Core intelligence driving personalization.
- **Video Coaching Interface**
    - Enables live virtual coaching sessions.
    - Supports remote coaching and global access.
- **Subscription System**
    - Manages individual and corporate subscription plans.
    - Enables recurring revenue.
- **Secure Payment System**
    - Processes payments between users and coaches.

    - Supports the platform's commission-based revenue model.
- **Analytics Dashboard**
    - Provides reports and insights for corporate clients.
    - Tracks engagement, performance, and coaching outcomes.
- **Progress Tracking & Goal Setting**
    - Allows users to set development goals.
    - Tracks measurable progress during coaching programs.
- **Feedback & Rating System**
    - Allows users to review coaches.
    - Improves quality assurance and platform transparency.
- **Data Security & Encryption**
    - Protects user data and financial transactions.
    - Ensures compliance with data privacy regulations.

2. Professionals Seeking Coaching (Demand Side)

Role in the system

- Individuals seeking career development, leadership coaching, and skill improvement.

Key problems faced

- Lack of personalised career guidance.
- Coaching sessions are often expensive.
- Difficulty finding credible and verified coaches.
- Lack of measurable progress tracking.

Interactions with the platform

- Create user profiles.
- Use AI matching to discover coaches.
- Book coaching sessions.
- Make subscription payments.

- Track personal development progress.

External drivers influencing this group

- Increasing demand for upskilling.
- Growth of remote work culture.
- Rapid AI and digital transformation in industries.

3. Corporate Clients (Organisations / HR Departments)

Role in the system

- Companies purchasing coaching services for employee development.

Key challenges faced

- Low employee engagement.
- High employee turnover.
- Lack of scalable coaching infrastructure.
- Limited visibility of ROI from training programs.

Interactions with the platform

- Purchase bulk coaching subscriptions.
- Allocate sessions to employees.
- Monitor engagement through analytics dashboards.
- Receive performance reports and insights.

Value received from the platform

- Measurable employee development outcomes.
- Improved workforce productivity.
- Data-driven talent development decisions.

4. Professional Coaches (Supply Side)

Role in the system

- Certified professionals offering coaching services through the marketplace.

Key challenges faced

- Difficulty acquiring clients independently.
- Revenue instability from irregular bookings.
- Limited access to global markets.

Interactions with the platform

- Create coach profiles.
- Conduct coaching sessions via the video interface.
- Update client progress data.
- Receive payments through the platform.

Benefits gained

- Access to a global client base.
- Stable demand through platform exposure.
- Revenue generation through commission-based sessions.

5. External Technology Infrastructure

These external entities support the technical operation of the platform.

Investors

- Provide funding for platform development and scaling.
- Expect long-term growth and profitability.

Payment Gateway Providers

- Enable secure online financial transactions.
- Build trust and credibility in payment processes.

Cloud Hosting Providers

- Provide infrastructure for hosting the platform.
- Enable scalability, storage, and system reliability.

6. Regulatory Environment

Regulatory authorities influence how the platform operates.

Key responsibilities

- Enforcing data protection and privacy laws.
- Ensuring ethical data usage.

Major regulatory consideration

- Compliance with GDPR and other data privacy regulations.

Potential risk

- Regulatory compliance failures could lead to legal and financial consequences.

7. Market and Competitive Environment

The platform operates within a competitive digital coaching market.

Competitors

- BetterUp
- CoachHub

External pressures

- Economic pressure on companies to justify training investments.
- Increasing competition from digital coaching platforms.

Strategic response

- Differentiation through:
    - AI-powered coach matching
    - measurable progress tracking
    - corporate analytics dashboards.

8. Technological and Industry Trends

Several broader trends influence the ecosystem.

Key trends

- Growth of remote work environments.
- Increasing demand for professional upskilling.
- Advancements in cloud computing and artificial intelligence.
- Digital transformation in corporate learning and development.

These trends create favourable conditions for the adoption of online coaching platforms like Ascend.

9. Overall System Interaction

The rich picture shows how multiple actors interact through the central platform:

- **Professionals** access coaching services.
- **Coaches** provide expertise and coaching sessions.
- **Corporate clients** invest in employee development.
- **External infrastructure providers** enable system functionality.
- **Regulatory bodies** ensure data protection compliance.

Together, these interactions form a digital coaching ecosystem that enables scalable, data-driven professional development.

Appendix A2 - SWOT Analysis Chart

STRENGTHS (Internal)	WEAKNESSES (Internal)
S1. AI-assisted skill-gap-based matching algorithm. S2. Hybrid revenue model. S3. Advanced corporate analytics. S4. Integrated Marketplace + LMS system.	W1. 'Cold Start' marketplace problem. W2. Limited initial brand trust vs. established firms. W3. Long B2B enterprise sales cycles.
OPPORTUNITIES (External)	**THREATS (External)**
O1. Corporate shift toward remote professional development. O2. Growing demand for measurable ROI in corporate L&D. O3. Underserved SME market segment.	T1. Large tech platforms replicating matchmaking features. T2. Economic downturns reducing corporate training budgets. T3. Coach disintermediation risk (bypassing platform).

Figure 07 - SWOT Analysis Chart

Appendix B

Appendix B1 - AI Use Declaration

1. Signed Statement

All strategic decisions, business concepts, system designs, analysis models, and conclusions were developed collaboratively by the group members. Where Generative AI tools were used, they were utilised only to support clarity, structure, grammar refinement, and idea organisation.

Signed on behalf of the group:

Saad Mazhar | Humayra Shajahan | Raahim Aslam | Dhuwarakesh Vijayakumar
Ayash Azhar

2. Generative AI Tools Used

The following AI-assisted tools were used during the preparation of this coursework:

- ChatGPT (OpenAI)
- Gemini (Google)
- Claude (Anthropic)
- Grammarly
- Microsoft Copilot

3. Explanation of Use

ChatGPT (OpenAI):
Used to assist with structuring report sections, refining academic language, improving clarity of explanations, and organising business concepts into coherent formats. It was also used to generate template structures (e.g., Business Model Canvas formatting guidance). All content was critically reviewed, edited, and validated by the group.

Gemini (Google):
Used for cross-verification of business terminology and alternative phrasing suggestions to improve readability and clarity. No final analysis was directly copied without group modification.

Claude (Anthropic):
Used to explore alternative structuring approaches for reflective writing and to compare different academic tone variations.

Grammarly:
Used exclusively for grammar checking, spelling correction, and sentence structure improvement.

Microsoft Copilot:
Used within Microsoft Word to support formatting consistency, table alignment, and document presentation quality.

Appendix B2 - Website Link

https://www.ascendos.online/

Appendix C

Appendix C1 - Meeting Minutes

Meeting 01

Section	Details
Meeting	Meeting 1
Date	28th January
Location	IIT - GP Square
Time	2:00 PM - 4:00 PM
Meeting Type	Initial Ideation & Team Formation
Attendees	Saad Mazhar Humayra Shajahan Raahim Aslam Ayash Azhar Dhuwarakesh Vijayakumar
Agenda	• Formation of project teams • Brainstorming potential business ideas

	● Understanding coursework requirements
Discussion Summary	The meeting began with forming the final project team and reviewing the coursework brief for the Information Driven Entrepreneurship module. The group discussed expectations, marking criteria, and key deliverables, including the written report and presentation. A brainstorming session followed, where multiple online business ideas were proposed, including: - An e-Coaching digital marketplace - An agricultural ecosystem platform supporting farmers - A student mentorship matching platform - A skill-based micro-learning subscription platform Each idea was discussed in terms of feasibility, scalability, market demand, and alignment with the module theme of information-driven entrepreneurship.
Decisions Made	Two ideas were shortlisted for further evaluation:– e-Coaching Platform– Agriculture Ecosystem Platform
Action Items	● Conduct preliminary research on both ideas ● Identify competitors and market trends ● Prepare a comparison discussion for the next meeting

Meeting 02

Section	**Details**
Meeting	Meeting 2
Date	8th February
Location	IIT - GP Square

Time	1:00 PM - 3:00 PM
Meeting Type	Idea Confirmation & Lecturer Feedback
Attendees	Saad Mazhar Humayra Shajahan Raahim Aslam Ayash Azhar Dhuwarakesh Vijayakumar
Agenda	● Review research findings ● Present ideas to the lecturer ● Decide final project direction
Discussion Summary	The team presented both shortlisted ideas to the lecturer for feedback. The agriculture ecosystem platform was identified as impactful but complex due to infrastructure, regulatory, and domain-specific challenges.The e-Coaching platform was seen as more aligned with digital business models, scalability, and data-driven decision-making. The lecturer highlighted the importance of demonstrating how the platform would use information strategically (e.g., matchmaking algorithms, analytics dashboards, performance tracking).The team discussed competitive platforms such as online coaching marketplaces and analysed differentiation opportunities such as corporate dashboards, AI-driven coach matching, and structured performance tracking.
Decisions Made	● Final business idea selected: e-Coaching Platform ● Focus to be placed on the platform-based marketplace model
Action Items	● Define target market segments (individuals vs organisations) ● Develop initial business model canvas ● Outline system features

Meeting 03

Section	Details
Meeting	Meeting 3
Date	11th February
Location	IIT – GP Square
Time	3:00 PM – 5:00 PM
Meeting Type	Business Model Development
Attendees	Saad Mazhar Humayra Shajahan Raahim Aslam Ayash Azhar Dhuwarakesh Vijayakumar
Agenda	● Define value proposition ● Identify revenue streams ● Assign report sections
Discussion Summary	The team refined the value proposition of the e-Coaching platform: "To provide an accessible, data-driven marketplace connecting individuals and organisations with verified professional coaches." Key features discussed included verified coach profiles, a booking and scheduling system, secure payment integration, corporate dashboards, a rating and feedback system, and data analytics for performance tracking. The team explored multiple revenue models, including commission per session, subscription model for organisations, and premium listing fees for coaches.

Decisions Made	● Adopt a hybrid revenue model (commission + subscription) ● Structure the report into market analysis, business model, technical architecture, and financial viability
Action Items	● Begin writing the assigned sections ● Conduct competitor benchmarking

Meeting 04

Section	**Details**
Meeting	Meeting 4
Date	21st February
Location	Via Google Meet
Time	7:00 PM – 9:00 PM
Meeting Type	Progress Review
Attendees	Saad Mazhar Humayra Shajahan Raahim Aslam Ayash Azhar Dhuwarakesh Vijayakumar
Agenda	● Review drafted sections ● Identify gaps in analysis ● Discuss technical architecture

Discussion Summary	Each member presented progress on their assigned report sections. Market research data was reviewed, highlighting growth in online coaching and remote professional development. The team discussed platform architecture (web-based application), database structure for coach and client profiles, data privacy and security considerations, and scalability of cloud-based hosting. The importance of incorporating information-driven elements such as data analytics, personalised recommendations, and KPI dashboards was emphasised.
Decisions Made	● Include a system architecture diagram ● Add risk analysis section
Action Items	● Finalise remaining research ● Prepare draft presentation outline

Meeting 05

Section	Details
Meeting	Meeting 5
Date	25th February
Location	Via Google Meet
Time	8:00 PM – 10:00 PM
Meeting Type	Report Finalisation & Presentation Planning
Attendees	Saad Mazhar Humayra Shajahan

	Raahim Aslam Ayash Azhar Dhuwarakesh Vijayakumar
Agenda	• Review the full draft • Edit and refine content • Plan a video presentation
Discussion Summary	The full report draft was reviewed collectively. Minor revisions were made to strengthen academic language and clarify the distinction between e-business and e-commerce classifications. The team structured the video presentation covering: introduction to the problem, market opportunity, business model, information-driven elements, financial overview, and conclusion. Roles were assigned for speaking segments.
Decisions Made	• Final proofreading responsibilities assigned • Confirm video shoot logistics
Action Items	• Final edits before submission

Meeting 06

Section	**Details**
Meeting	Meeting 6
Date	2nd March
Location	Grand Spaces - Astoria
Time	4:00 PM – 7:00 PM

Meeting Type	Finalisation & Video Shoot
Attendees	Saad Mazhar Humayra Shajahan Raahim Aslam - Joined Virtually Ayash Azhar Dhuwarakesh Vijayakumar - Joined Virtually
Agenda	● Final report confirmation ● Record a video presentation
Discussion Summary	The team completed final proofreading and formatting of the report. All references were checked and aligned with Harvard referencing guidelines. The video presentation was recorded, ensuring a clear explanation of the e-Coaching platform, demonstration of information-driven business elements, and professional delivery. Multiple takes were recorded to ensure clarity and coherence.
Decisions Made	● Final version approved by all members ● Submission ready
Outcome	Report and video finalised and prepared for submission.

Appendix C2 - Workload Matrix

Task / Contribution Area	Saad (CEO)	Humayra (CTO)	Dhuwarakesh (CPO)	Raahim (CMO)	Ayash (COO)
Initial Idea Generation & Concept Validation	✓ Lead ideation, vision setting	✓ Technical feasibility input	✓ User problem framing	✓ Market demand validation	✓ Operational practicality
Market Research & Industry Overview	✓	X	X	✓	✓
Competitor Analysis (BetterUp, CoachHub, etc.)	X	✓	✓	✓	X
Revenue Model & Monetisation Strategy	✓	✓	X	X	X
Target Market & Audience Definition	X	✓	✓	X	X
Executive Summary	✓	X	X	X	X
1.1 Introduction	✓	✓	X	✓	X
1.2 The Business Idea	✓	X	✓	X	✓
1.3 Revenue Model & Monetisation Strategy	✓ Pricing & strategic logic	✓ Platform scalability cost analysis	✓ Subscription UX logic	✓ Competitive pricing benchmarking	✓ Cost structure & margin validation
1.4 Target Market & Audience	X	X	✓	X	X
1.5 Mission Statement	X	X	✓	X	✓
1.6 Rich Picture	✓	X	X	X	X
1.7 E-Business Classification	X	✓	X	✓	X
1.7.1 Form of Operation	X	✓	✓	✓	✓
1.7.2 Degree of Digitisation	X	✓	X	✓	X
1.7.3 Classification by Participants	✓	✓	X	X	✓
1.7.4 E-Marketplace Classification	✓	X	X	X	X
1.8.1 Industry Overview	X	X	X	✓	✓

1.8.2 Major Competitors Identification	✓	X	✓	X	X
1.8.3 Competitor Analysis	✓	✓	✓	X	✓
1.8.4 Competitive Advantage Strategy	X	✓	X	X	X
1.9 Feasibility Justification	✓	X	✓	X	✓
1.10 Video Pitch Script & Planning	✓ The Problem	✓ The Solution	✓ What Makes Us Unique	✓ Market Opportunity & Model	✓ Vision & Why Invest
2.1 IT Strategy Introduction	✓	X	X	✓	X
2.2 Strategic Tool Justification	✓ Tool selection logic	✓ Tech relevance input	X	✓ Industry relevance input	✓ Risk perspective input
2.3.1 Porter's Five Forces	X	X	X	✓	X
2.3.2 SWOT Matrix	X	X	X	X	✓
2.3.3 PESTEL Analysis	X	X	✓	X	X
2.4 Business Model Canvas	✓	✓	X	X	X
2.5 IT Strategy Alignment	X	✓	X	✓	X
2.6 Strategic Positioning	X	✓	X	✓	X
2.7 Summary of Business Strategy	✓	X	✓	X	✓
3.1 User Requirements Introduction	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
3.2.1 System Actors Identification	✓	✓	X	X	X
3.2.2 Functional Requirements	X	✓	✓	✓	X
3.2.3 Non-Functional Requirements	✓	X	X	X	✓
3.2.4 Requirements Mapping Table	✓	✓	X	X	X
3.3 Use Case Diagram	✓	X	✓	X	✓
3.4 Formal Use Case Description	✓	X	X	X	✓

3.5 Additional UML Model	X	X	X	✓	✓
3.6 Design Justification & Alignment	X	X	✓	✓	✓
3.7 Conclusion	✓	X	X	X	X
Task 4 Individual Reflection	✓ Individual submission	✓ Individual submission	✓ Individual submission	✓ Individual submission	✓ Individual submission
Meeting Minutes (1–6)	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Final Report Editing & Referencing	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓